

ESSENTIALS ONLY

Berdia Monson

The family financial plan — short version



Prepared for Grandma · May 2026

Monson Family · Jefferson County, Arkansas

Berdia Monson

The important parts — in plain language, without the extra detail.

Why This Exists

This is a summary of what the family is proposing for the land, solar lease, and restaurant. It is written so you can read it once and understand the big picture.

This is not a vote. No one is being asked to give up anything. The goal is to organize and protect what you already own — and to carry out your wishes clearly for the generations after you.

What You Own Today

- **109 acres** in Jefferson County — in your name. **Not for sale.**
- **Solar lease** on 94.75 acres — 30-year contract with Orion. Rent starts when construction finishes (target summer 2026, may slip).
- **Restaurant** at Grider Field — operating ~10 years. Stanley runs it day to day. Set to be inherited by Stanley.
- **Coin collection** — Darius's inheritance (value pending appraisal).
- **Life insurance** — full picture still being gathered; may be larger than discussed on April 12.

What Does *Not* Change

- ✓ **No land is sold.** It stays in the family.
- ✓ Reneta, Charles, and Kim keep receiving their **16.67%** of solar income — paid directly to them, every year.
- ✓ Stanley keeps running the restaurant.
- ✓ You still define the rules. The trust carries out **your** wishes — it does not take control away from you while you are able to decide.
- ✓ No family member is asked to personally guarantee loans or take on debt.

Your Solar Income

When the solar farm is fully operating, the lease pays **\$800 per acre per year** on 94.75 acres — **\$75,800 total**. Payments go up **2% each year**. They are usually paid **once a year**, not monthly.

YOUR SHARE (50%)

\$37,900

per year when rent starts · ~\$3,158/mo equivalent

PERSON	SHARE	YEAR 1
You (Grandma)	50%	\$37,900
Reneta	16.67%	\$12,630
Charles	16.67%	\$12,630
Kim	16.67%	\$12,630
Total	100%	\$75,800

Under the plan, your 50% is managed through the trust so it can be reinvested and protected — not spent down. The children's shares continue going to them directly.

What Is a Trust?

A **trust** is a legal box that holds assets for the family. You set the rules. A **trustee** (Stedmon, with a bank as backup) manages the box according to your rules. The family receives income from what the trust owns — but the land and businesses stay protected inside the trust.

What the trust would do for you

- ✓ Keep the land together and protect it from forced sale
- ✓ Hold the restaurant under a written contract that protects Stanley's role
- ✓ Pay property taxes and upkeep so land is not lost to unpaid bills
- ✓ Borrow against solar income to grow family businesses — **without selling land**
- ✓ Pass assets to grandchildren in an orderly way — not through probate court

One Decision When Rent Starts

The first year of full solar rent is a one-time choice. No one currently depends on that money — which is why the family may decide together before habits form.

OPTION A — ALL YEAR-ONE TO TRUST

Everyone skips year-one checks.
The trust receives the full **\$75,800** as seed money. Normal payments resume in year two.

OPTION B — PAY AS USUAL

Each person receives their share in year one — you **\$37,900**, each child **\$12,630**. The trust still borrows to fund growth; it just starts without extra cash on hand.

Either way: Land stays in the family. Ownership shares do not change.
This decision has not been made yet — the family will discuss it before rent starts.

Why Now

- Solar construction is coming — once rent starts flowing, it is harder to reorganize.
- The trust should be in place **while you can still define how assets are governed**.
- No one relies on solar income for daily expenses today — that makes now the right time to set things up cleanly.

What Happens Next

1. **April 12 meeting done** — family reviewed the plan together.
 2. **Now (May–June)** — gather documents, hire trust attorney and CPA, clean up restaurant books.
 3. **Summer 2026** — form trust and transfer assets (when attorney and CPA are ready).
 4. **When solar is built** — full rent begins; family decides year-one option if needed.
 5. **After that** — trust deploys capital slowly, one step at a time, with family oversight.
- Bi-weekly Sunday check-ins continue so everyone stays aligned.

Questions?

Stedmon prepared this summary. Reneta, Stanley, and the rest of the family are part of the conversation. Ask anything — there are no bad questions.

The full brief has charts, numbers, and detail for family members who want to go deeper: berdia-family-plan.vercel.app